

# Assignment 4

2026-06-14

```
library(flexclust)
library(factoextra)
```

```
## Loading required package: ggplot2
```

```
## Welcome to factoextra!
```

```
## Want to learn more? See two factoextra-related books at https://www.datanovia.com/en/product/practice
```

```
library(tidyverse)
```

```
## -- Attaching core tidyverse packages ----- tidyverse 2.0.0 --
```

```
## v dplyr      1.2.1      v readr      2.2.0
```

```
## v forcats   1.0.1      v stringr   1.6.0
```

```
## v lubridate 1.9.5      v tibble    3.3.1
```

```
## v purrr     1.2.2      v tidyr     1.3.2
```

```
## -- Conflicts ----- tidyverse_conflicts() --
```

```
## x dplyr::filter() masks stats::filter()
```

```
## x dplyr::lag()     masks stats::lag()
```

```
## i Use the conflicted package (<http://conflicted.r-lib.org/>) to force all conflicts to become errors
```

```
Pharmaceuticals<- read.csv("~/Desktop/Pharmaceuticals.csv")
```

```
my_data<- Pharmaceuticals
```

```
names(my_data)
```

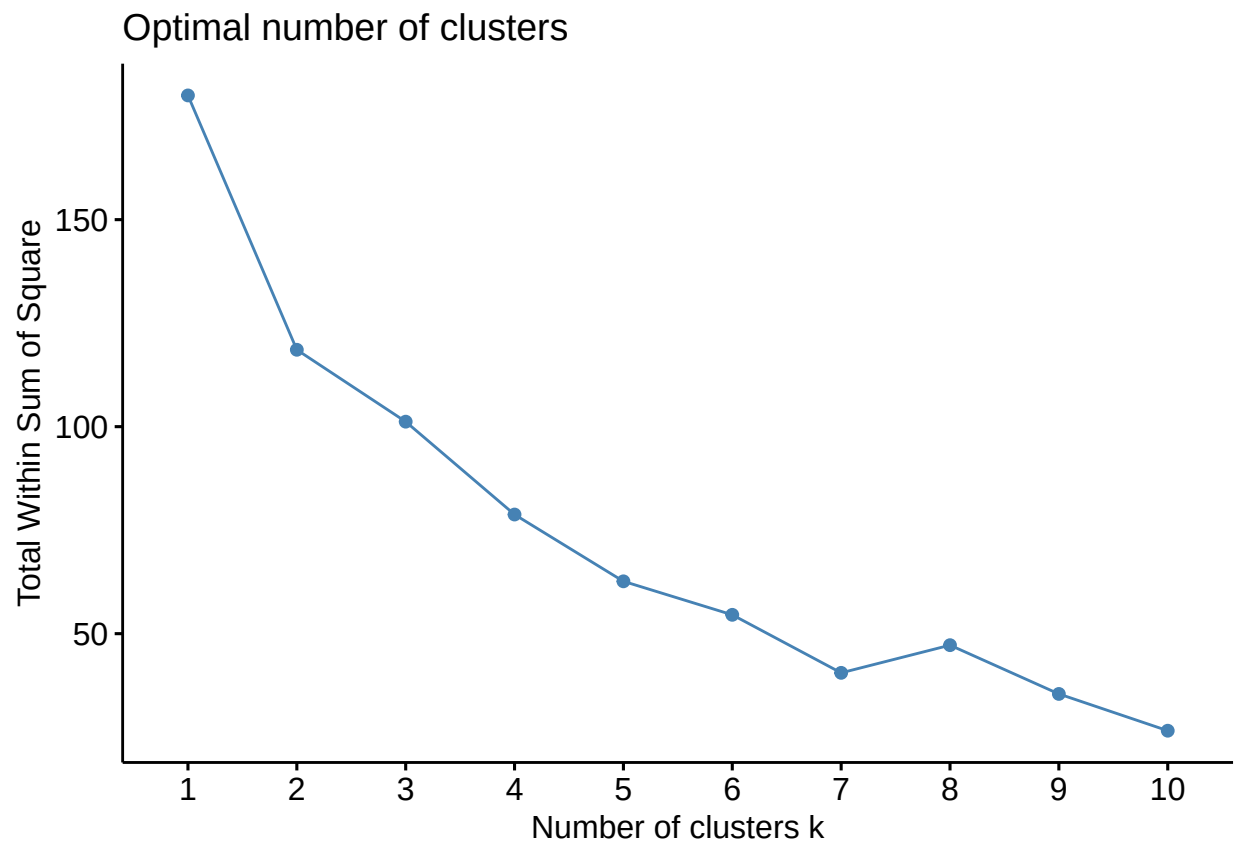
```
## [1] "Symbol"           "Name"              "Market_Cap"
## [4] "Beta"             "PE_Ratio"          "ROE"
## [7] "ROA"              "Asset_Turnover"    "Leverage"
## [10] "Rev_Growth"       "Net_Profit_Margin" "Median_Recommendation"
## [13] "Location"         "Exchange"
```

## Part A

```
pharma_num<- my_data[, 3:11]
```

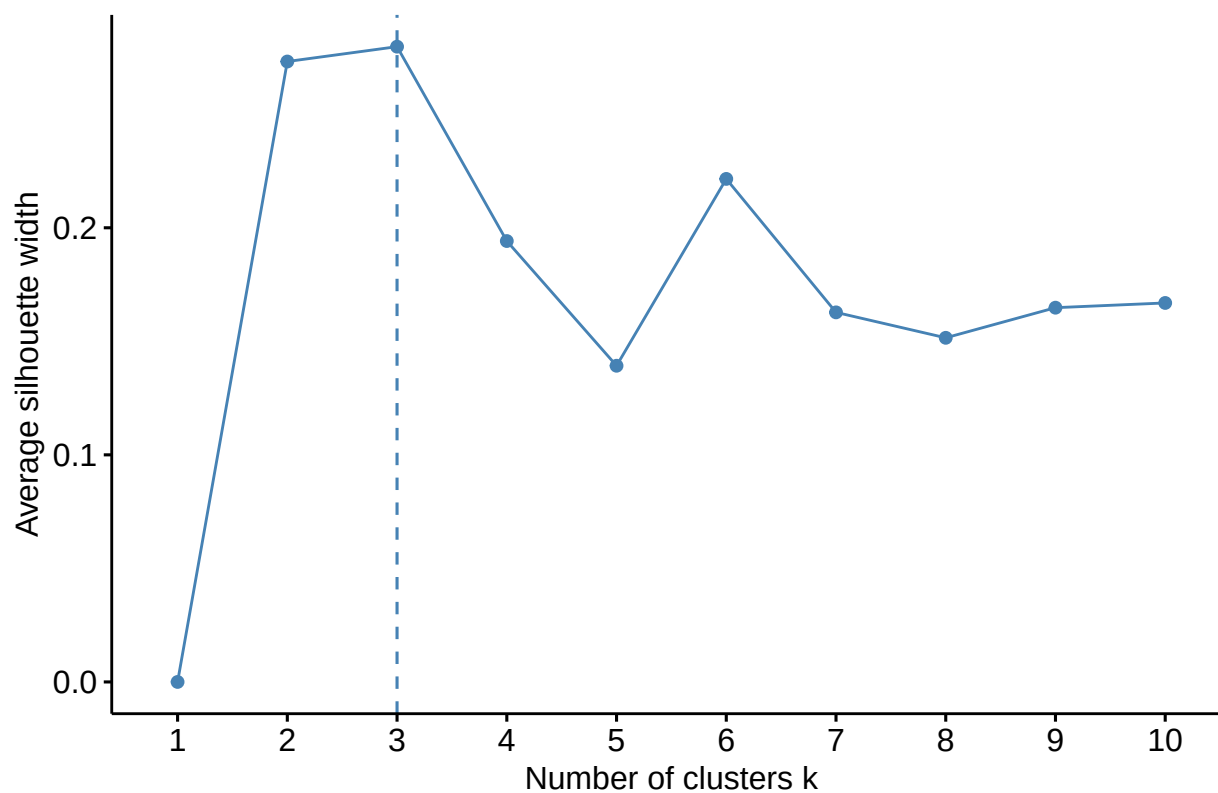
```
pharma_scaled<- scale(pharma_num)
```

```
fviz_nbclust(pharma_scaled, kmeans, method = "wss")
```



```
fviz_nbclust(pharma_scaled, kmeans, method = "silhouette")
```

Optimal number of clusters (method = "silhouette")



```
set.seed(123)
```

```
kmeans_pharma <- kmeans(
  pharma_scaled,
  centers = 2,
  nstart = 25
)
```

```
kmeans_pharma
```

```
## K-means clustering with 2 clusters of sizes 11, 10
```

```
##
```

```
## Cluster means:
```

```
##   Market_Cap      Beta  PE_Ratio      ROE      ROA Asset_Turnover
## 1  0.6733825 -0.3586419 -0.2763512  0.6565978  0.8344159    0.4612656
## 2 -0.7407208  0.3945061  0.3039863 -0.7222576 -0.9178575   -0.5073922
##   Leverage Rev_Growth Net_Profit_Margin
## 1 -0.3331068 -0.2902163      0.6823310
## 2  0.3664175  0.3192379     -0.7505641
```

```
##
```

```
## Clustering vector:
```

```
## [1] 1 2 2 1 2 2 1 2 2 1 1 2 1 2 1 1 1 2 1 2 1
```

```
##
```

```
## Within cluster sum of squares by cluster:
```

```
## [1] 43.30886 75.26049
```

```
## (between_SS / total_SS = 34.1 %)
##
## Available components:
##
## [1] "cluster"      "centers"      "totss"        "withinss"     "tot.withinss"
## [6] "betweenss"    "size"         "iter"         "ifault"       "
```

The numerical variables Market\_Cap, Beta, PE\_Ratio, ROE, ROA, Asset\_Turnover, Leverage, Rev\_Growth, and Net\_Profit\_Margin were used for clustering. Because these variables are measured on different scales, the data were standardized using z-score scaling. Equal weights were assigned to all variables after standardization. The elbow method and silhouette method were used to determine the appropriate number of clusters. Both methods suggested that two clusters provided the best separation of the firms. Therefore, k-means clustering was performed using two clusters. A seed value of 123 was used for reproducibility and `nstart = 25` was used to improve cluster stability.

## Part B

```
my_data$Cluster <- as.factor(kmeans_pharma$cluster)

cluster_summary <- aggregate(
  pharma_num,
  by = list(Cluster = my_data$Cluster),
  FUN = mean
)

cluster_summary
```

```
##   Cluster Market_Cap      Beta PE_Ratio  ROE      ROA Asset_Turnover  Leverage
## 1      1    97.11364 0.4336364 20.95455 35.7 14.95455      0.80 0.3254545
## 2      2    14.24300 0.6270000 30.42000 14.9  5.63000      0.59 0.8720000
##   Rev_Growth Net_Profit_Margin
## 1   10.16455      20.17273
## 2   16.89800      10.77000
```

Cluster 1 consists of large, established pharmaceutical firms. These companies have substantially higher market capitalization, profitability (ROE and ROA), and asset turnover than firms in Cluster 2. They also have lower beta and leverage, suggesting lower risk and more stable financial performance. In addition, Cluster 1 has a considerably higher net profit margin (20.17% versus 10.77%). However, their revenue growth is lower than firms in Cluster 2, indicating that they may be mature companies with slower growth prospects.

Cluster 2 consists of smaller pharmaceutical firms with higher expected revenue growth. These firms have higher beta, leverage, and P/E ratios, indicating greater risk and stronger growth expectations. However, they generate lower returns on equity and assets, lower asset turnover, and lower net profit margins than firms in Cluster 1, suggesting they are less profitable and less operationally efficient.

## Part C

```
table(my_data$Cluster, my_data$Median_Recommendation)
```

```
##
##      Hold Moderate Buy Moderate Sell Strong Buy
##  1      6          3          2          0
##  2      3          4          2          1
```

```
table(my_data$Cluster, my_data$Location)
```

```
##
##      CANADA FRANCE GERMANY IRELAND SWITZERLAND UK US
##  1          0      0          0          0          1 2 8
##  2          1      1          1          1          0 1 5
```

```
table(my_data$Cluster, my_data$Exchange)
```

```
##
##      AMEX NASDAQ NYSE
##  1      0      0    11
##  2      1      1     8
```

Some patterns are present in the variables that were not used to form the clusters. With respect to analyst recommendations, Cluster 1 contains more firms with Hold recommendations, while Cluster 2 contains slightly more Buy and Strong Buy recommendations. This is consistent with Cluster 2's higher expected revenue growth despite its lower profitability.

With respect to location, Cluster 1 consists entirely of firms headquartered in the United States, United Kingdom, and Switzerland, while Cluster 2 contains firms from a more diverse set of countries, including Canada, France, Germany, and Ireland. This suggests that the smaller, higher-growth firms are more geographically diverse.

With respect to stock exchange, all firms in Cluster 1 are listed on the NYSE. In contrast, Cluster 2 contains firms listed on the NYSE, NASDAQ, and AMEX. Therefore, Cluster 2 exhibits greater diversity in exchange listings, while Cluster 1 is concentrated on a single exchange.

## Part D

### Cluster 1: Large Established Pharmaceutical Firms

This cluster contains firms with large market capitalizations, high profitability, high asset efficiency, low leverage, and relatively stable financial performance. Although growth rates are lower, these firms appear to be mature and financially strong organizations.

### Cluster 2: Smaller High-Growth Pharmaceutical Firms

This cluster contains firms with smaller market capitalizations, higher expected revenue growth, higher leverage, and greater market risk. These companies appear to be growth-oriented firms with stronger future growth expectations but lower current profitability.

```
fviz_cluster(kmeans_pharma, data = pharma_scaled)
```

Cluster plot

